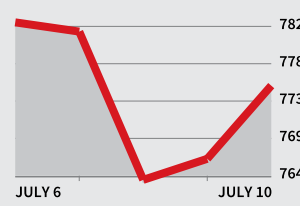


SENSEX 77569.39 (-194.52)



IN FOCUS

	Week's close	Week's change
Nifty 50	24206.90	-63.95
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.04	-0.07
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.32	+0.11
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	142794.00	-2964
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	220390.00	-13468

AIMING HIGH.

India must have a stronger seaplane network, considering its coastline and inland water bodies, says Aviation Minister K Rammohan Naidu **p3**



INFLATION FORECAST.

Driven by surging food costs, retail inflation is projected to breach the 4% mark in June **p2**

QUICKLY.

WINNING MINDS

India wins 5 gold medals at Physics Olympiad



Chennai: India put up a standout performance at the 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026, held in Colombia from July 5 to July 12, with five students clinching gold medals. In the country-wise medals tally, India was placed at the first position, jointly with China, Kazakhstan, Russia, South Korea and Taiwan. This is the second time that India has won five gold medals at the IPhO, the other occasion being in 2018. **p2**

TRACXN DATA

Solar module firms woo more private investors

Chennai: Indian solar module makers have caught the attention of private market investors as they scale their manufacturing presence and move further into upstream components like cells, wafers and ingots. According to data from Tracxn, over the past five years, private investments in module manufacturing companies have gone up nearly ten-fold in value. In 2026, these companies raised \$460 million in equity funding. **p2**

TCS backs sovereign AI, in talks with Indian developers

ALLAYS FEARS. Concerns over access curbs to Mythos are overblown: CEO Krithivasan

Vallari Sanzgiri
Thomas K Thomas
Mumbai

Amid growing concerns over AI sovereignty and access to frontier models, TCS has begun discussions with Indian AI model developers, and said the country will need sovereign AI capabilities for sensitive workloads.

“India will need a sovereign model because you do not want to lose to the outside world, where you do not have complete control,” said K Krithivasan, CEO and MD at TCS, in conversation with *businessline*. TCS is also building smaller, domain-specific language models for customers using its own capabilities. The comments come at a time when governments and enterprises are increasingly examining the risks of relying exclusively on global AI platforms amid rising geopolitical tensions, export controls and evolving regulations around advanced AI technologies.

AI READINESS

However, Krithivasan played down concerns that restrictions on access to cutting-edge AI models could put Indian technology companies



India will need a sovereign model because you do not want to lose to the outside world, where you do not have complete control

K KRITHIVASAN,
CEO and Managing Director, TCS



at a disadvantage. Referring to recent debates over restricted access to frontier models like Anthropic’s Mythos, he said the issue had been “overblown” because most enterprises were yet to fully exploit the capabilities of AI models already available to them.

“While there is always a question of why Mythos is not available to me, a common question we ask customers is: What did you do with the model available to you before?” he said, arguing that concerns over access to the latest models were “not a major disadvantage” at this stage.

Instead, enterprises are increasingly adopting a pragmatic approach, choosing different AI models depend-

ing on cost, performance and the nature of workloads. TCS expects customers to use a mix of proprietary, open-source and small language models rather than depend on a single provider.

Krithivasan said AI revenues would continue to be “lumpy” as most AI transformation engagements are short-duration projects rather than traditional multi-year outsourcing contracts.

TCS follows a narrow definition of AI revenue, counting only projects where AI delivers measurable business outcomes. While such projects conclude within two or three quarters, he said the company sees significant headroom as enterprises begin re-

designing entire business value chains around AI.

On whether technology vendors such as Microsoft, which are expanding Forward Deployed Engineer teams to work directly with enterprises, could emerge as competitors, he said system integrators would remain relevant because they understand customers’ business processes and technology environments. “The thesis we have been putting out is that the role of system integrators will only increase,” he said, adding that AI vendors may have deep product expertise but lack the customer context that companies such as TCS bring to large transformation programmes.

CLIENT SENTIMENT

On concerns that enterprises had been slower than expected in scaling AI deployments, Krithivasan attributed it to the complexity of large organisations.

“It’s one thing to do a POC and find what looks good. Making it, productionising, scaling it and seeing the true business benefit takes some time. That’s why you have to reimagine the whole process,” he said.

Interview p10

SBI Funds Management IPO creates 13 crorepati employees

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The much-awaited SBI Funds Management (SBIFM) initial public offering (IPO) will not only make its promoters and the government laugh all the way to the bank but also reward some of its top employees handsomely.

The country’s largest fund house, which introduced an employee stock option plan (ESOP) in 2018, has been rewarding its long-serving top management employees with liberal stock options. Now, the IPO will make 13 of them crorepatis. This is probably a testimony to the industry’s tagline: “Mutual Fund Sahi Hai”.

The fund house’s Deputy Managing Director, Devinder Pal Singh, who is one of its longest-serving



employees, owns 21,14,004 shares worth ₹121 crore at the upper band of the offer price of ₹574 a share. That’s not all.

He has outstanding ESOPs of 5,19,300 shares worth another ₹30 crore, according to data sourced from the Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP).

An MF industry veteran, Singh joined SBIFM on January 1, 2006. Previously, he was associated with SBI as a Senior Management Grade Scale-V officer.

The fund house’s Chief Investment Officer, Srinivasan Rama Iyer (fondly known as

Vasan) owns ESOPs of 18,24,728 shares, worth ₹105 crore, and has outstanding ESOPs of 8,94,800 shares worth ₹51 crore.

Similarly, the 10,19,236 shares owned by Srinivas Jain, Chief of Strategy, Digital & Technology and Head of Investor Relations, under ESOPs are worth ₹59 crore. Besides, his outstanding ESOPs of 1,70,720 shares are worth another ₹10 crore.

EEYING OVER ₹11,600 CR

The promoters of the fund house — SBI and European fund management company Amundi India Holdings — will offload 12.83 crore shares and 7.54 crore shares, respectively, to collectively rake in ₹11,692 crore. The government is expected to collect ₹1,400 crore from the selling promoters as long-term capital gains tax.

The ESOPs of Rajeev

Radhakrishnan, Chief Investment Officer - Fixed Income, and Aparna Nirgude, Chief Risk Officer, are worth ₹36 crore and ₹31 crore, respectively.

Vinaya Datar, Chief Compliance Officer, Company Secretary and Head Legal, could walk away with ₹21 crore from her availed ESOPs of 3,59,340 shares.

OTHER CROREPATIS

The other crorepati employees of SBI Funds Management include Mohan Lal (Fund Manager - Alternatives), Inderjeet Ghuliani (Chief Financial Officer), Mahesh Chhabria (Fund Manager, Corporate Debt Market Development Fund), Rajat Grover (Chief Human Resources Officer and Head, Corporate Social Responsibility) and Sanjay Pugaonkar (Chief Information Security Officer).

Parandur airport decision is State’s call, says Centre

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Civil Aviation Ministry has not received any intimation from the newly-elected Tamil Nadu government, led by the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), on whether it intends to proceed with the proposed ₹27,000 crore greenfield airport at Parandur or put it on hold, according to highly placed sources.

“We have not received any intimation from the State government about its plans for the second airport. We are not aware whether they are putting it on hold or are proceeding with it. We had issued the approval for the land some time ago,” Ministry sources said.

Details p2

Rising cancer cases generate up to 25% revenue for top private hospitals

Overwhelmed and under-resourced public hospitals push patients to high-cost private care

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi



COST BURDEN. Even with insurance, families often end up paying several lakhs of rupees from their pocket

Cancer treatment now accounts for between 17 and 25 per cent of hospital revenue at India’s largest private healthcare chains, reflecting how the country’s rising cancer burden has shifted from overstretched government hospitals to the private sector.

With the ICMR’s National Cancer Registry Programme estimating 15.7 lakh new cancer cases in 2025, rising to 22.2 lakh by 2040, Delhi-NCR has emerged as the country’s biggest oncology hub as a significant share of cancer burden falls on northern States like Uttar Pradesh, which is estimated to record 2,10,958 new cancer cases, while Bihar is expected to report 1,09,274 cases.

As patients from these and adjoining States travel to Delhi-NCR for treatment,

the region is the biggest hub for cancer care.

PRICEY CARE

Smaller private hospitals have rushed to add oncology departments. For patients, timely treatment comes at a steep price, with one chemotherapy cycle at a private hospital costing from ₹30,000 to over ₹2 lakh, radiation therapy ₹2-5 lakh, cancer surgery ₹3-10 lakh, targeted therapies and immunotherapy ₹1-4 lakh per cycle, and bone marrow transplants ₹15-40 lakh.

Even with insurance, families often end up paying several lakh rupees from their own pockets.

An AIIMS Delhi oncologist said public institutions are “overwhelmed and under-resourced”, with “too few surgeons, medical oncologists and functional radiotherapy machines”, leading to “long waits, which can critically affect patient outcomes”.

Lady Hardinge Medical College, TSCI and Maulana Azad Medical College face similar shortages, he said.

Private hospital chains have capitalised on the demand. According to Max Healthcare’s Q3 FY26 earnings update, oncology contributed 25.1 per cent of inpatient revenue, generating an estimated ₹1,560 crore in the first nine months of FY26. “Oncology contributes over 25 per cent of our overall revenues, reflecting both strong demand and the growing complexity of cancer care,” said Group Medical Director Sandeep Budhiraja.

REVENUE MIX

Apollo Hospitals’ FY25 annual report shows oncology accounted for 17 per cent of its inpatient specialty revenue mix, translating into an estimated ₹1,900 crore from cancer care. Medanta’s FY25 disclosures show that oncology-related specialties contributed 14 per cent of revenue. Fortis Healthcare’s CEO, in the Q1 FY26 earn-

ings call, said oncology had overtaken cardiology as its largest therapeutic segment, contributing 16.4 per cent of hospital revenue and 19-20 per cent after including cancer-related procedures.

Smaller hospitals are also moving aggressively into oncology. Sir Ganga Ram Hospital has opened a multi-disciplinary cancer centre, Yatharth Super Speciality Hospital has launched a Centre for Cancer and Radiation Oncology in Greater Noida, Everhope Oncology has raised \$10 million to build cancer centres in Delhi and Mumbai, M|O/C Cancer Care has opened centres in Delhi and Gurugram, and Fortis is planning a centre in Manesar.

According to SVS Deo, Oncology Lead and Senior Consultant at Max Healthcare, “30-40 per cent of future growth in the sector will come from cancer care.”

Hormuz closure threatens India’s gas, crude supplies

Amiti Sen
Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Fresh escalation in West Asia following the US attack on Iran and Tehran’s declaration that it has again shut the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) threatens to disrupt India’s hydrocarbon supplies, particularly liquefied natural gas and liquefied petroleum gas, while also raising concerns over crude oil imports and higher costs for exporters.

Government and industry officials said India had some immediate buffer as refiners had topped up crude, LPG and LNG cargoes during the recent sanctions reprieve. However, a prolonged disruption to shipping through the strategic waterway could recreate the supply tightness witnessed in March-April this year.

“India has been able to make up for some lost cargoes of LPG and LNG. For now, there are supplies. However, if this escalation extends, leading to the SoH becoming un-navigable, the March-April 2026 shortage scenario could return,” a government source said.

CLOSE WATCH

Another senior official described the situation as “tense and fluid”, saying the government is monitoring developments closely and is in touch with stakeholders to ensure the safe movement of crude oil, LPG, LNG and chemical cargoes.

A refinery official said, “At present, vessel traffic is not happening through the SoH. There will be shadow tanker activity. No one can say for sure what will happen next or how will the conflict de-



FUEL IMPACT. Exporters said the biggest immediate fallout would be through energy prices rather than shipping disruptions

escalate. For now, it’s wait and watch.”

He added that refiners would continue relying on crude from Russia, the US, West Africa and South America, and LPG and LNG imports from the US, reverting to sourcing arrangements that existed before the Iran sanctions reprieve.

The SoH carries roughly a fifth of global crude oil trade and a substantial share of the world’s LNG shipments, making any prolonged disruption a major concern for energy-importing countries such as India.

DISRUPTIONS SEEN

Exporters said the biggest immediate fallout would be through energy prices rather than shipping disruptions.

Since commercial container traffic had not resumed through the Strait even after the temporary ceasefire, the latest escalation had mainly extinguished hopes of an early return to normalcy while threatening to raise fuel and freight costs.

Federation of Indian Export Organisations Director General Ajay Sahai said there would be no immediate deterioration in container movement because commercial cargoes were already avoiding the Strait.

“The disruption is simply

getting prolonged,” he said.

EEPC India Chairman Pankaj Chadha said engineering exporters were more worried about gas availability than shipping. “Container traffic through the Strait never really reopened. The difference now is that whatever hope we had of normal shipping resuming has disappeared.”

He added that manufacturers had begun receiving better gas supplies after the initial truce, and gas prices had started softening from July 1. “Now, it appears the situation will reverse again. Gas prices are likely to rise, and industries that had just begun recovering from shortages may once again face the same problems,” Chadha said.

India condemns attack on vessel

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

India on Sunday condemned an attack on a Cyprus-flagged commercial vessel off the coast of Oman that left one of its 11 Indian crew members missing.

As West Asia witnessed fresh hostilities, India said the targeting of commercial shipping and civilian infrastructure in the region must end.

Details p3

Attractive rates on FCNR Deposits

5 yrs

4-5 yrs

3-4 yrs

6.60%

6.25%

6.15%

Bank of Maharashtra

Zen Lyfe

Bringing Global Saving options to you

Business

Advances

Retail

Vehicle Loan

Deposits

CASA

19.10%

26.90%

24.59%

56.89%

12.93%

48.51%

UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ In Crore)

	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30/06/2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30/06/2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31/03/2026 (Audited)
RoA	Total Income from Operations (Net)	9063.29	7878.82	32822.53
	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (Before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Items)	2276.76	1702.52	7857.37
NIM Domestic	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Items)	2276.76	1702.52	7857.37
	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Items)	2020.19	1592.76	7019.32
Cost to Income	Paid up Equity Share Capital	7691.55	7691.55	7691.55
	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) - as on date	26076.53	20648.31	23597.18
Gross NPA	Securities Premium Account	3867.25	3867.25	3867.25
	Net Worth	32780.38	27699.34	30272.42
Net NPA	Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt %*	15.50	25.32	17.05
	Debt** Equity Ratio	0.72	0.63	0.70
PCR	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) - not Annualized	2.63	2.07	9.13
	Capital Redemption Reserve	----	----	----

*Total Debts & Outstanding Debt represents total borrowings of the Bank.

**Debt represents borrowings with residual maturity of more than one year.

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and 52 read with regulation 63(2) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites (BSE: www.bseindia.com and NSE: www.nseindia.com) and Bank's website (www.bankofmaharashtra.bank.in)

Place: Pune

Date: 10/07/2026

Sushanta Kumar Mohanty
Executive Director

Prabhat Kiran
Executive Director

Nidhu Saxena
Managing Director & CEO

Bank of Maharashtra

Scan for Results

QUICKLY.

VOC Port inks cooperation pact with Belgian port

Chennai: In a step towards strengthening India-Europe maritime cooperation, the V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Port of Antwerp-Bruges International NV (PoABI), Belgium, and APEC Antwerp-Flanders Port Training Center (APEC), Belgium, to explore cooperation in capacity building, green port initiatives and digital transformation of port operations. The three-year agreement complements the VOC Port's growing portfolio of green energy partnerships, the release said. **OUR BUREAU**

Emirates plans A380 services to Hyderabad

Hyderabad: Dubai-based carrier Emirates is ready to introduce its flagship Airbus A380 services to Hyderabad. During a meeting with Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy, Mohammed Sarhan, Vice-President (India), Emirates, conveyed the airline's willingness to deploy A380 aircraft on the Hyderabad route as the airline marked 25 years of operations in the city. Welcoming the proposal, Reddy urged the airline to expand its flight frequencies from Hyderabad to meet rising passenger demand. **OUR BUREAU**

Private investor interest in solar module firms on the rise

BIG LEAP. Policy support, strong domestic demand have brought sector on their radar

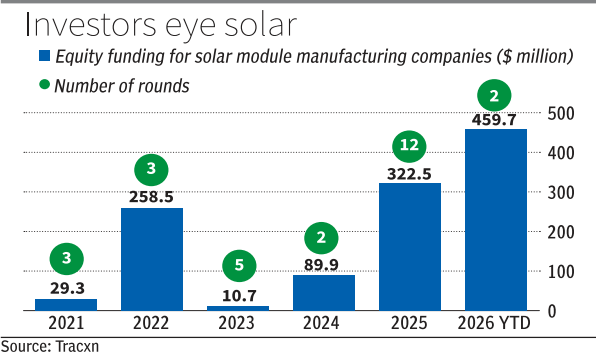
Rohan Das
Chennai

Solar module makers in India have caught the attention of private market investors as they scale their manufacturing presence and move further into upstream components like cells, wafers and ingots.

According to data from market research firm Tracxn, over the past five years, private investments in module manufacturing companies have gone up nearly ten-fold in value.

In 2026 (YTD), these companies raised about \$460 million in equity funding, while in 2025, the figure was around \$322.5 million. This is a significant spike compared to \$29.3 million in 2021.

Goldi Solar's ₹1,422 crore raise from Havells and other private investors, GREW Solar bagging ₹1,050 crore from Bay Capital Investment Ltd, alongside institutional investors, and ReNew Photo-voltaics' \$100 million raise from the development financing institution British International Investment were some of the marquee deals



over this period. The share of each investor could not be ascertained as Tracxn tracks value of the entire round.

Speaking to *businessline*, industry stakeholders said that in the past, the majority of capital came from strategic investors.

However, policy support, alongside strong domestic demand, had brought the sector on the radar of private equity and venture capital firms.

RISE IN CAPACITY

Ankit Jain, Vice-President, Co Group Head - Corporate Ratings, ICRA, suggested that India's module manufacturing capacity stood at more than 200 GW as of June 2026, a sharp rise from 67.3

GW as of February 2025.

"On the demand side, there has been sizeable capacity addition with schemes such as PM Kusum and PM Surya Ghar supporting module demand, while policies like ALMM, PLI and improved access to financing have enabled manufacturers to scale up capacity," he said.

Vineet Bhatia, Partner-Renewables, Grant Thornton Bharat, suggested that module manufacturing had evolved from being a commodity business to being a significant growth opportunity.

"Historically, low margins, high import dependence and challenges in scaling up operations kept venture capital and private

equity interest in solar manufacturing low, and the sector was mainly driven by strategic investors whose focus was more integration over financial returns. Nonetheless, the outlook is drastically changing now," he said.

Recent policy signals from the Centre on mandatory domestic sourcing will require large-scale investments, he added.

"Companies are planning a phase-wise capital investment in the industry, beginning with cells in the near term, wafers and ingots in the medium term, and eventually extending to the broader ecosystem," Bhatia said.

Shilpa Kumar, Managing Director and Head of India, British International Investment, said, "Building globally competitive manufacturing capacity requires patient capital and an enabling ecosystem; it cannot be assessed through the lens of near-term utilisation alone. Our focus is on backing businesses with strong fundamentals, sound governance and the ability to remain competitive over the long term."

Centre says no communication with TN on Parandur airport

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Union Civil Aviation Ministry has not received any intimation from the newly-elected Tamil Nadu government, led by the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), on whether it intends to proceed with the proposed ₹27,000 crore greenfield airport at Parandur or put it on hold, according to highly placed sources.

"We have not received any intimation from the State government about its plan for the second airport. We are not aware whether they are putting it on hold or proceeding with it. We have already issued the approval for the land," Ministry sources said.

The ball is now in the State's court, and any decision on the project's future rests with the State government, the sources added.

The clarification comes amid growing speculation over the fate of the proposed airport after the formation of the TVK government.

Statements by senior Ministers have indicated that environmental concerns cannot be compromised for development projects, meaning that the project could be shelved and an alternative site identified.



MAJOR DECISION. Government sources said there is no legal restriction preventing the TVK administration from discontinuing the project despite its Special Project status **VELANKANNI RAJ B**

Meanwhile, *businessline* has learnt from sources that a delegation of senior Tamil Nadu government officials is scheduled to visit New Delhi on Monday to hold discussions with Central government officials on various projects supported by agencies such as the World Bank and the Asian Development Bank. It remains unclear whether the Parandur airport project will be part of those discussions.

PROJECT REVIEW

Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay had, before assuming office, backed villagers and farmers opposing the project over concerns on loss of livelihood and environmental impact. Since taking charge, there has been speculation that he has reviewed the project, although no details have been made public.

Senior State government officials have denied that any

such discussions have taken place.

One of the final gazette notifications issued by the previous DMK government declared the Parandur New Greenfield Airport Project a "Special Project" under the Tamil Nadu Land Consolidation (for Special Projects) Act, 2023. The notification was issued on March 2, days before the Model Code of Conduct came into force.

However, government sources said there is no legal restriction preventing the new administration from discontinuing the project despite its Special Project status.

Industry representatives have warned that scrapping the airport would be a setback for Chennai, arguing that the city had already lost passenger and cargo traffic to neighbouring Hyderabad and Bengaluru, and that a second airport would help arrest that trend.

SEBI employees will need to liquidate all 'non-permitted investment'

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Taking lessons from the controversy involving its former Chairperson, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has amended regulations governing employee service.

A new clause has been added prescribing liquidation of all non-permitted investment at the time of joining. In addition, employees will need to disclose details of their professional interests during the last three years.

These changes are part of the amendments to 'The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Employees' Service) Regulations', published in the official gazette on July 11.

In the substituted regulation 64 related with 'Restrictions on investment', the

SEBI EMPLOYEE RULE CHANGES

- Family members to include spouse, dependent children (including step, adopted), person for which employee is legal guardian, any other person related to by blood or marriage to the employee or his spouse and substantially dependent on such employee
- Employee to disclose all negotiation, agreement for future employment within 30 days
- Gifts above the value of ₹50,000 received from friends on the occasion of marriage or any other event needs to be reported



term 'non-permitted investment' has been used for restriction on an employee or his family members during the employee's period of service with SEBI.

The term includes investments in equity, instruments

convertible into equity and investment or trading in derivatives of equity or commodity.

However, investment through a pooled investment vehicle — if the scheme of such pooled investment

vehicle is professionally managed by an entity regulated by any financial sector regulator — and investment in units of InVITs and REITs will not be part of 'non-permitted investment'.

FAMILY INVESTMENTS

A new regulation 64A has been added, which prescribes relaxation from restrictions on investments by family members during an employee's period of service.

Accordingly, there will be no restriction on shares acquired by the spouse under an employee stock options plan.

"In case of technical violations arising out of actions of spouse and/or dependent family members, such an inadvertent action shall not be treated as misconduct by the employee affecting his career progression. However, in appropriate cases, penalty

imposed may be in the nature of monetary penalty," the regulation clarified.

Under the new regulation 64, at the time of joining, the employee may liquidate the non-permitted investment or freeze them for the entire service period.

Another option would be disclosing a trading plan to the Office of Ethics and Compliance (OEC) in SEBI for selling of non-permitted investment.

TRANSITION TIMELINE

In case non-permitted investments are not liquidated at the time of joining, then the employees neither can exercise voting right, nor can receive share on account of corporate action or sub-ordinate action or scribe the right issue during employment period.

For existing employees, a timeline will be prescribed to exercise these options.

Regulation 66 has also been substituted. Accordingly, the employee will have to give details of financial investments and liabilities pertaining to him and to his family members along with details of non-permitted investments.

"The disclosures shall be made by the employee to OEC at the time of his joining the services of the Board as well as at the time of exit from the services," it said, while adding that for the employees who were in the services of the Board at the time of coming into force of this amendment, disclosures may be done within the timeline as may be specified.

Changes in details of family members or relatives, contract of renting out or transactions in immovable property (purchase, sale, gift, inheritance) will need to be reported in 30 days.

Rural demand drives CV retail growth in June 2026

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The commercial vehicle (CV) industry reported healthy growth in June 2026, with retail sales rising 17 per cent year-on-year to 90,972 units from 77,836 units in June, 2025.

Rural markets emerged as the key growth engine with a 22 per cent year-on-year growth, significantly outpacing the 13 per cent growth in urban areas as goods movement strengthened across smaller towns and hinterland regions, according to the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) data.

Dealers cited steady freight activity, e-commerce-linked movement and norm-

Commercial vehicle retail sales (in units)				
OEM	June 2025 sales	Market share (%)	June 2026 sales	Market share (%)
Tata Motors	25,311	32.5	30,991	34.1
Mahindra & Mahindra*	20,483	26.3	25,015	27.5
Ashok Leyland**	14,152	18.2	15,337	16.9
VE Commercial Vehicles	7,471	9.6	7,937	8.7
Maruti Suzuki India	3,391	4.4	4,436	4.9

*Includes Mahindra Last Mile Mobility Ltd **Includes Switch Mobility Source: FADA Research

alising supplies, FADA said.

According to FADA data, the growth was led by Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra, both of which strengthened their positions in the market, while some established players such as Ashok Leyland and VE Commercial Vehicles lost market share despite higher volumes.

Tata Motors retained its lead with sales of 30,991 units in June 2026, up from 25,311 units a year earlier, registering growth of 22.4 per cent. Its market share improved by around 2 percentage points, reinforcing its dominance in the CV segment.

Mahindra & Mahindra emerged as the second-

largest player, reporting sales of 25,015 units compared with 20,483 units in June 2025, a growth of 22.1 per cent. Within this, Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd accounted for 23,241 units, while Mahindra Last Mile Mobility Ltd contributed 1,774 units.

Ashok Leyland recorded sales of 15,337 units, up from 14,152 units a year ago, posting growth of 8.4 per cent.

However, its market share declined. Its subsidiary Switch Mobility Automotive nearly doubled its volume to 308 units in June 2026 as against 159 in June 2025.

SMALLER PLAYERS

The industry performance reflects strong demand for medium and heavy commercial vehicles and light com-

mercial vehicles, while competitive pressures remain intense for smaller OEMs, industry trackers said.

Poonam Upadhyay, Director, Crisil Ratings, said the healthy year-on-year growth points to broad-based strength in demand across key sectors.

"Robust growth in light CVs and medium CVs reflects sustained momentum in logistics, regional transportation and passenger mobility, supported by economic activity and infrastructure development. Heavy CV growth was relatively moderate at 8 per cent, reflecting the sector's continued shift towards higher-capacity vehicles that enable greater freight movement per vehicle and enhance fleet productivity," she said.

NTPC board clears ₹20,457 cr for Chhattisgarh's 1,600 MW project

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

State-run power giant NTPC board has approved ₹20,456.70 crore investment for the 1,600 MW Lara Super Thermal Power Project Stage-III in Chhattisgarh, the company said in an exchange filing on Saturday.

On June 5, the state-run company had sought bids from technology solutions players to help its sub-critical thermal power units operate at lower load and ensure flexibility for the electricity distribution network to use both thermal and renewable energy more efficiently.

Five gold medals for India at International Physics Olympiad in Colombia

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

India put up a stand-out performance at the 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026, held in Colombia from July 5 to July 12, with five students clinching gold medals. In the country-wise medals tally, India was placed at the first position jointly with China, Kazakhstan, Russia, South Korea and Taiwan. This is the second time that India has won five gold medals at the IPhO, the earlier occasion being in 2018.

This was India's 27th appearance at the Olympiad. In all these years, nearly 44 per cent of Indian students have



GOLD RUSH. The winning Indian team with mentors at the International Physics Olympiad

won gold medals, another 41 per cent silver, 10 per cent bronze and 5 per cent honourable mentions, said representatives of the Homi Bhabha Centre for Science Education (HBCSE), the anchor institution for the team.

In the last 10 years, all Indian students at IPhO have

won either gold (62 per cent) or silver (38 per cent) medals.

DIVERSE TOPICS

The special prize for overall winner went to a South Korean student; the award for best in the experimental component went to a stu-

dent from Iran. In all, 51 gold, 80 silver and 97 bronze medals were awarded. A total of 381 students from 85 countries participated in the competition.

The 5-hour theoretical competition featured three problems based on diverse topics like the thermody-

namics of paramagnetic cooling, photoionisation of ozone and dynamics of electron-positron pairs, among others.

As per information from HBCSE, all Indian students excelled in the theoretical examination, some reaching close to perfect scores.

"The experimental competition, also of five hours, challenged students to explore several phenomena related to thermodynamic processes in fluids and heat transfer. The Indian students also performed remarkably well in the experimental component," said HBCSE representatives.

Anwesh Mazumdar of HBCSE - TIFR, who accompanied the team to the event,

told *businessline* that across both the theory and experiment rounds, the team displayed "exceptional diligence", leaving little scope to deduct marks.

"According to the data that we have, 64 per cent of Olympiad medallists have chosen an academic career (defined by pursuing a PhD, in any subject), and 32 per cent of medallists, academic or not, have settled in India," he added, speaking about their career path.

The team comprised Kanishk Jain from Pune, Riddhesh Anant Bendale from Indore, Rishit Garg from Dwarka (New Delhi), Shresth Suriaya from Mumbai, and Svarit Joshi from Ahmedabad, who won gold.

TO ADVERTISE
PLEASE CONTACT

- Chennai : 044 - 28576300
Coimbatore : 0422 - 2212572
Madurai : 0452 - 2528497
Trichy : 0431 - 2302801
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thehindu **businessline.**

FORM NO. NCLT. 3A Advertisement detailing Appeal [see rule 35] Company Appeal (C/Act) 4KOB/2025 Notice of Appeal

A Company Appeal under Section 59 of the Companies Act, 2013, for rectification of the register of members of **God's Own Country Health Resorts International Private Limited** (CIN: U85199KL2001PTC014890), was presented by **Mr. Anilkumar Santhamma Pillai Gopinathan** through his Power of Attorney holder, **Mr. Sunilkumar G.S** on the 31st day of July 2025, and the said Appeal is fixed for hearing before the Kochi bench of National Company Law Tribunal on **22.07.2026**. Any person desirous of supporting or opposing the said Company Appeal should send to the Appellant's advocate, notice of his intention, signed by him or his advocate, with his name and address, so as to reach the Appellant's advocate not later than two days before the date fixed for the hearing of the Company Appeal. Where he seeks to oppose the Company Appeal, the grounds of opposition or a copy of his affidavit shall be furnished with such notice. A copy of the Company Appeal will be furnished by the undersigned to any person requiring the same on payment of the prescribed charges for the same.

Dated 09.07.2026 **Mr Sunilkumar G.S**
Chamolli House, Pampalli, Perinad P.O
Kollam - 691601; PPhone no.: 9746994523

FORM NO. NCLT 3A ADVERTISEMENT DETAILING PETITION [SEE RULE 35 OF THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL RULES, 2016] IN THE MATTER OF SCHEME OF ARRANGEMENT OF DEMERGER BETWEEN ACUMEN CAPITAL MARKET (INDIA) LIMITED AND ACUTIES CAPITAL MARKET PRIVATE LIMITED COMPANY PETITION CP (CAA) NO. 7/KOB/2026 IN CAA (CA) NO. 3/KOB/2025

ACUMEN CAPITAL MARKET (INDIA) LIMITED
CIN: U67120KL1995PLC008674, 38/1431, ST Reddair Building, Veecksham Road, Emakulam, Kerala, India - 682 035
Represented by its Managing Director, Sri Akshay Agarwal
: **Applicant No. 1 / Transferee Company**

AND
ACUTIES CAPITAL MARKET PRIVATE LIMITED
CIN: U68120KL2001OPT0026074
64/3344, Veecksham Road, Emakulam, Kerala, India - 682 035
Represented by its Director, Sri Akshay Agarwal
: **Applicant No. 2 / Transferee Company**

NOTICE OF PETITION

A petition under Sections 230 to 232 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 read with the Companies (Compromises, Arrangements And Amalgamations) Rules, 2016 and Rule 11 of the National Company Law Tribunal Rules, seeking approval of Scheme of Arrangement (Demerger) between Acumen Capital Market (India) Limited and Acuties Capital Market Private Limited was presented jointly by the Petitioner Companies on June 4, 2026, and the said petition is fixed for hearing before the National Company Law Tribunal, Kochi Bench on July 31, 2026. Any person desirous of supporting or opposing the said petition should send to the Petitioners' office, a notice of his intention, signed by him or his Advocate/ Representative, with his name and address, to reach the Petitioners' office not later than two days before the date fixed for the hearing of the petition. Where he seeks to oppose the petition, the grounds of opposition or a copy of his affidavit shall be furnished with such notice. A copy of the petition will be furnished by the undersigned to any person requiring the same on payment of the prescribed charges for the same.

Date: 13.07.2026
Place: Emakulam **Sd/-**
Aravind Sreekumar
Counsel for the Petitioner Companies

ON THE CAMPAIGN TRAIL.

It's good to see more brands talking the language of the young and relying on humour, occasionally being cheeky. But the question is whether they are taking it too far?

Red hot mystery

Last Thursday, readers woke up to see the front page of a newspaper covered in red and lettered with the words “Happy 18th birthday to us. Thank you for keeping us in your hearts (and bank statements)”. Below was the cheeky inscription “no logo required, you know who we are :)”

Overconfidence? Agreed the brand had been building recall around its distinctive red identity, but on social media people thought of Airtel, Kotak Mahindra Bank and several others with the red code. Without a category identifier (and a red herring in the “bank statements” line) there was confusion. Verdict: The teaser was bold but foolish.

Maxxing it

Fastrack's latest campaign, 'Gelato Maxxing', featuring actor Siddhant Chaturvedi, takes its “Never Same, Never Sane” philosophy in a deliciously unexpected direction. Inspired by the rise of the “maxxing” culture, where young consumers unapologetically immerse themselves without moderation in the things they love, the campaign cleverly connects gelato scoops with watches. Chaturvedi digs into gelato scoop after scoop, even as he straps on watch after watch on his arm, right up to the elbow — the glossy, pastel-hued, textured dials are inspired by gelato. What's more, beyond the campaign, Fastrack has partnered with Bengaluru-based premium gelato brand Milano to co-create the Fastrack x Milano Gelato Truck, taking the world of “gelato maxxing” directly to consumers. An insane idea that works brilliantly.

Football at the table

Teaming up with Coca-Cola, Westlife Foodworld, which owns and operates McDonald's restaurants across West and South India, has launched a limited-time ‘Football Meals’ campaign. Building on its growing line-up of limited-edition merchandise, from tote bags and sippers to bag charms and socks, the brand taps into FIFA fever to create a shareable meal that comes with an exclusive McDonald's India x Coca-Cola football collectible. Family meal, football, cola and fun moments. Together, the two brands score!

The missing N

Mobile phone brand OnePlus mixes things up nicely in a lighthearted campaign to promote its new N6 phone. The ad features a podcast-style interaction between playback singer Himesh Reshammiya and a Gen Z host, and the ask is that the letter ‘N’ should be avoided in the conversation. Reshammiya finds himself navigating hilarious moments, lyric callbacks and awkward fumbles, before the narrative culminates in the reveal of the OnePlus N6. A simple idea that combines humour, nostalgia, music and fun, and firmly spotlights the new product.

STATIONS AND STRATEGIES

Private radio’s fight to get its voice heard

AUDIO MAKEOVER. From live IPs to digital content and tier-3 reach, FM channels are tuning into multi-platform audience preferences

Chitra Narayanan

For the radio industry, the headlines in recent months have been traumatic. Last month, HT Media pulled the plug on Radio Nasha in Mumbai, Radio One in Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru, and Fever FM in Chennai, surrendering the licences for the popular stations. Last month also saw TV Today's retreat from FM with the shutdown of Ishq 104.8 FM and the completion of asset transfer to Abhijit Realtors. Earlier in the year, the Sun TV Network-owned Red FM surrendered its MagicFM Mumbai licence.

Private radio players cite the unsustainable licence fees and spectrum usage fees as a huge structural challenge. Broadcasters must pay an annual licence fee based on either 4 per cent of their gross revenue or 2.5 per cent of the non-refundable one-time entry fee (NOTEF) for a city — whichever is higher. As the NOTEF bidding prices were very high in metro cities a decade ago, stations have been locked into paying huge fees that don't match their current dwindled income. Ad revenues have fallen since the rate cuts made during the Covid-19 pandemic never really corrected. Adding insult to injury, audio streaming platforms, which pose a big threat to FM players, carry none of the costs nor content restrictions. FM radio operators have been petitioning regulatory bodies to de-link annual fees from the entry fee, and allow them to broadcast news and current affairs — something that the TRAI has also recommended.

Despite the challenges, some players have survived and grown their audiences. How have they



MAKING AIRWAVES. (Clockwise from top left) Nisha Narayanan, Director and COO, Red FM; Rahul Namjoshi, CEO, MyFM; Ashit Kukian, CEO, Big FM; and a promo for Aha Zindagi, hosted on MyFM by actor Anupam Kher



done it? In fact, DB Corp-owned MyFM actually acquired 14 channels at last year's auctions. Conversations with the leaders of Red FM (which has 68 stations across 67 cities), MyFM (44 stations, including the 14 new ones) and an energised Big FM (67 stations), which was acquired by Sapphire Media from Reliance Broadcast Network, are illuminating. These players have rewritten the audio playbook to

structure math meeting market reality”. Besides the licence fees, GST at 18 per cent vs 5 per cent for comparable media adds to the burden of FM channels, she says.

According to her, the survivors share one trait: They stopped being single-format businesses well before the financial pressure became visible. “We do on-ground, we do digital, and we do content and radio,” she stresses.

For Red FM, live IP has become a core business line and not an add-on, she says. Its annual South Side Story cultural event, showcasing the South in northern cities, is a big hit and heading into its eighth season. Last season, it attracted 12,000-plus people on ground and, as Narayanan points out, the event lives on on the airwaves for months afterwards. “Brands prefer long-term IP partnerships instead of standalone sponsorships because they provide consistent audience engagement,” says Narayanan.

Red FM has also been building artist/concert partnerships — for instance, Seedhe Maut Tour, Anoushka Shankar Tour and so on.

On the same frequency is Ashit Kukian, CEO, Big FM, who says the channel's new philosophy is ‘One Big World’, its integrated media and entertainment ecosystem, which brings together radio, digital content, creator-led storytelling, experiential platforms, live entertainment and emerging media solutions. “Through Big FM Experiences and Big Vibe, we are building IP-led platforms that allow brands to engage with audiences beyond traditional broadcasting,” he says.

Interestingly, MyFM CEO Rahul Namjoshi, while acknowledging the station does a large number of on-ground events, says, “We prefer to remain a radio-first company.” On the nature of the events, he says

most are local in nature because that's where radio creates the strongest impact. “On podcasts, our approach is also radio-first. We create podcast-style content featuring our popular RJs, who are celebrities in their own markets, and we also collaborate with well-known personalities whenever relevant.”

Why did MyFM bid for more channels in the Phase 3 auction last year, at a time when most people shied away from participating? Says Namjoshi, “The environment is definitely challenging, but every challenge also creates an opportunity if you have conviction. Our decision to acquire 14 new stations was based on our strong belief in the growth story of Bharat.”

Namjoshi believes that in tier-2 and tier-3 markets, where local businesses are expanding and consumers have a strong affinity for local content in their own language, local media has a tremendous future.

FM broadcasters are doing multiple things and assert that their audiences are growing. However, Narayanan rues that there is no robust audience measurement framework for radio.

“Over 12,700 brands advertised on radio in 2025 and ad volumes grew 2 per cent year-on-year, which tells you demand exists,” she says. “Radio continues to be a highly resilient and relevant medium, driven by its trust, accessibility, hyperlocal connect and ability to build a strong sense of companionship with listeners,” asserts Big FM's Kukian.

There are many problems that Narayanan says the industry can solve collectively. Radio is not losing India; it's deepening its hold, she insists. All that the broadcasters want is a level-playing field for their voices to become louder.

Cannes dichotomy: The lion and the login screen



This year's Cannes Lions handed its Film Grand Prix to an advertisement for Anthropic's Claude, an AI assistant whose promise is that it won't show you ads. There was something ironic there. One of advertising's biggest prizes went to a commercial celebrating the banning of advertising.

That paradox defines the moment marketing finds itself in.

Every June, Cannes becomes advertising's global town square. Agencies, brands, creators and platforms descend on the French Riviera to celebrate creative excellence. Yet, walk along the Cannes palm-lined boulevard, the grand Palais des Festivals multi-purpose venue for the Cannes ad awards, and another story emerges.

Meta, Amazon, YouTube, Spotify and Reddit dominate the beaches, conversations and business meetings while inside the Palais, the biggest prizes still largely celebrate campaigns.

Neither is wrong. They're simply measuring different things.

For decades, marketing's primary output was communication: A television commercial, a print campaign, a radio spot or an outdoor idea. Today, creativity increasingly lives inside products, interfaces and systems. A recommendation engine, an AI assistant, a frictionless checkout or a brilliantly designed loyalty programme can create more lasting value than even the most memorable 30-second film.

Now wait. That doesn't make advertising less important. Good advertising is a critical part of marketing. You need to enter the customer's mind and stay there. That's the reason Coca-Cola or Haldiram keep winning. But advertising is no longer the only place where creativity generates competitive advantage.

I just saw an Ogilvy film on the World Cup that celebrates fans who “lost their voices” cheering for their teams — totally brilliant and involving, and no UI/UX can top that. But then no TV ad can top the Amazon user experience — and that's where it's at now.

This difference also explains why Cannes — the place — sometimes feels split in two. The awards celebrate traditional communication. The beaches celebrate platforms, technology. If the Palais is still the Durga Puja, the beaches increas-



ENGAGING. Coca-Cola's football World Cup-themed ‘Lost Voices’ ad

ingly resemble the streets with *gol-gappa* and *chaat* sellers, shoot-the-balloon stalls and nervous couples out on first dates.

The same contradiction appears in who wins. Large holding companies like WPP, IPG and Havas continue to dominate the medal tables. That isn't necessarily bias. Big networks, big brands can afford higher entry fees, dedicated awards teams and multiple submissions across categories. The Olympics isn't unfair because large countries win more medals — scale matters. Cannes is no different.

(On a side note, India's relatively lean performance this year deserves similar understanding. Fewer entries, tighter budgets, more selective participation, chan-

Did we tell a remarkable story? The other asks: Did we build something that changed the business? The strongest organisations increasingly do both.

Take the quick commerce platform Blinkit, for instance. Its yellow delivery maps, playful notifications and 10-minute promise are now as recognisable as any television campaign. Much of the brand is experienced before a single advertisement is seen. Zomato remains one of India's best advertisers, but its creativity extends well beyond campaigns. Live order tracking, witty app copy, restaurant discovery and product design are all part of the brand experience.

Skincare and haircare brand Minimalist spent relatively little on advertising mythology. Instead, clear packaging, transparent ingredients and a frictionless online experience became much of the marketing.

Cannes remains one of the world's most influential creative institutions. But as marketing expands into products, AI and customer experience, no single festival can be the sole arbiter of creative success.

The lion still matters. It may simply have to learn to share the stage with the login screen.

Shubho Sengupta writes about marketing, technology and culture from an intergenerational perspective

Has your brand become an everyday habit?

Why behavioural lock-in is the key to a consumer business’ extraordinary longevity, pricing power and premium valuation



When investors evaluate consumer businesses, they usually focus on three variables: Market size, market share and profitability. Yet, the most enduring competitive advantage often lies elsewhere — in consumer behaviour.

The world's most valuable consumer companies have not merely sold better products — they have also changed habits permanently. They have become the consumer's default choice. Once that happens, competition shifts from battles over price or features to one against human psychology.

History suggests that once consumers adopt a more convenient behaviour, they rarely return to the old one. This ex-

plains why some consumer businesses enjoy extraordinary longevity, pricing power and premium valuations. Their moat is not simply technology or distribution — it is also behavioural lock-in. India's consumption journey over the past 25 years illustrates this remarkably well.

NEW BEHAVIOURS

Entertainment was once synonymous with single-screen cinemas. Multiplexes transformed the experience through improved seating, cleaner facilities, superior technology and a family-friendly environment. Years later, OTT platforms again rewrote viewing habits by offering on-demand, personalised entertainment. India's pay TV subscriber base has steadily fallen down the years, while streaming continues to gain adoption.

Retail tells an even more compelling story. Consumers first migrated from neighbourhood stores to organised retail. They

then embraced e-commerce for wider assortment and doorstep delivery. Today, quick commerce is redefining convenience altogether.

Every successive innovation solved a small friction but created a disproportionately larger behavioural change. E-commerce eliminated the need to travel. Quick commerce is eliminating waiting itself.

Industry estimates suggest India's quick commerce market could continue growing at over 40 per cent annually over the next few years.

Payments reflect the same behavioural shift. India now processes more than 18 billion UPI transactions each month, making it the world's largest real-time payments ecosystem. Consumers no longer think about carrying cash, searching for change or swiping cards.

Mobility follows the same principle. Uber and Ola did not simply organise taxis, they also removed uncertainty. Con-



RINSE AND REPEAT. Products that never go out of style ISTOCK

sumers know the fare before the ride, track the driver in real time and complete payment automatically.

Food delivery offers another illustration. Domino's transformed India's pizza market by standardising quality, pricing and delivery. Swiggy and Zomato subsequently shifted restaurant

discovery itself. Increasingly, consumers decide what to eat inside an app rather than outside it. The platform has become the starting point of demand.

REDUCING FRICTION

Across these industries, a common flywheel emerges. Companies remove one layer of friction. The reduced friction increases usage frequency. Frequency creates habit. Habit generates data. Data improves personalisation. Improved personalisation further strengthens convenience, reinforcing the habit. Over time, this behavioural flywheel becomes an economic moat that competitors find extremely difficult to replicate.

This also explains why some platform businesses sustain premium valuations despite appearing expensive on traditional financial metrics. Investors are not simply valuing today's revenues or earnings — they are also valuing future consumer beha-

viour, which has already been conditioned. Amazon Prime subscribers consistently spend more than non-members. Netflix viewers rarely return to scheduled television. Apple users exhibit exceptional ecosystem loyalty.

These are not merely successful products — they are also behavioural monopolies.

WHAT'S NEXT

The next behavioural transition may already be underway.

For nearly three decades, consumers have interacted with the internet by searching. Search engines trained us to type keywords, browse links and compare websites before arriving at an answer. Generative AI challenges that behaviour altogether.

Instead of searching, consumers increasingly ask. AI removes the effort involved in discovering, filtering and synthesising knowledge.

If that behavioural shift con-

tinues, the economics of digital advertising, customer acquisition, search and brand discovery could be fundamentally rewritten over the next decade.

For investors, this offers a different way to analyse businesses. Instead of asking only whether market share will grow, perhaps the more important questions are: Has the product become the consumer's first instinct? Does its absence create inconvenience? Would switching back feel like a step backwards? If the answers are ‘yes’ then pricing power, customer retention and long-term profitability often follow naturally.

India's next decade of consumption will, therefore, be defined not solely by rising incomes or favourable demographics but also the businesses that become embedded in everyday routines. Is your brand becoming an everyday habit?

Karan Taurani is EVP, Elara Capital

GLOBAL BYTES.

Call to end 'reckless attacks' on seafarers

International Maritime Organisation Secretary-General Arsenio Dominguez has condemned the attacks on several ships transiting the Strait of Hormuz over the past few days. He



called for maximum restraint and de-escalation in the region. Hundreds of ships with around 6,000 seafarers remain stranded in the Persian Gulf since the beginning of the conflict in West Asia. "I regret that once again I am compelled to speak out following attacks on commercial ships and innocent

seafarers due to geopolitical circumstances beyond their control," he said. "These reckless attacks have again placed innocent seafarers in grave danger. No seafarer should have to risk their life simply for doing their job," he said.

The attacks intensify the fear, uncertainty and psychological strain endured by the stranded seafarers, he said.

DP World's growing truck fleet for GCC

DP World has acquired 700 trucks to expand its road freight network in the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) region and offer customers greater reliability and efficiency in moving cargo across the region.



The investment is part of the company's long-term strategy to build an integrated logistics network that connects ports and terminals, economic zones and digital platforms to provide end-to-end solutions across the supply chain.

The fleet will add up to 35,000 truck trips a month, supporting domestic and cross-border trucking for DP World's customer base in the GCC. The fleet will cater to first-, middle- and last-mile requirements and support the movement of containerised and non-containerised cargo, says a release.

GAGAN: Navigating India's skies with precision

India achieves first GAGAN-based precision landing by a commercial jet aircraft

Making GPS more accurate and reliable

- Continuously corrects positioning errors in real time
- Provides integrity information, instantly alerting pilots
- Delivers seamless navigation coverage
- Strengthens India's indigenous navigation capability
- Supports all phases of flight



Source: DGCA

RE POSTS.

Powering India's Green Future, One Shipment at a Time. V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority has achieved an impressive 117.72% growth in Windmill Blades handling cargo during April-June FY 2026-27 compared to the corresponding period of FY 2025-26.

This remarkable milestone reflects our growing capability in handling project cargo and our unwavering commitment to supporting India's renewable energy mission through efficient, reliable, and sustainable port operations. Driving green logistics. Strengthening trade. Enabling a sustainable tomorrow.

V.O.Chidambaranar Port Authority, Tuticorin @vocpa_tuticorin

A stakeholder consultation meeting was convened to review the implementation and progress of the One Nation One Port Process (ONOP) initiative.

The deliberations focused on harmonising port procedures across Indian ports to improve operational efficiency, reduce logistics costs, and enhance the ease of doing business. Through close collaboration with all stakeholders, ONOP aims to foster greater efficiency, transparency, and seamless operations across India's maritime sector, while strengthening the country's global competitiveness. The initiative aligns with the vision of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi to build a modern, integrated, and world-class port ecosystem.

Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways @shipmin_india

Truck rental rates

Rentals for 18-tonne payload

Truck route	Rentals as on		% change
	Jun 25	Jul 9	
Delhi-Mumbai-Delhi	1,75,000	1,76,000	0.57
Delhi-Nagpur-Delhi	1,58,000	1,59,000	0.63
Delhi-Kolkata-Delhi	1,79,000	1,80,000	0.56
Delhi-Guwahati-Delhi	1,95,000	1,96,000	0.51
Delhi-Hyderabad-Delhi	2,02,000	2,03,000	0.49
Delhi-Chennai-Delhi	2,18,000	2,19,000	0.46
Delhi-Bengaluru-Delhi	2,25,000	2,25,000	0.00
Delhi-Ranchi-Delhi	1,68,000	1,69,000	0.59
Delhi-Raipur-Delhi	1,65,000	1,66,000	0.60
Delhi-Kandla-Delhi	1,44,000	1,45,000	0.69
Mumbai-Chennai-Mumbai	1,74,000	1,75,000	0.57
Ludhiana-Hyderabad-Ludhiana	2,03,000	2,04,000	0.49
Mumbai-Kolkata-Mumbai	2,01,000	2,02,000	0.50
Chennai-Ahmedabad-Chennai	2,14,000	2,15,000	0.47
Bengaluru-Kolkata-Bengaluru	2,15,000	2,16,000	0.46
Bengaluru-Mumbai-Bengaluru	1,44,000	1,46,000	1.37
Delhi-Thiruvananthapuram-Delhi	2,83,000	2,84,000	0.35
Guwahati-Mumbai-Guwahati	2,85,000	2,86,000	0.35
Nagpur-Chennai-Nagpur	1,65,000	1,66,000	0.60
Kolkata-Guwahati-Kolkata	1,57,000	1,58,000	0.63
Indore-Delhi-Indore	1,46,000	1,48,000	1.35
Ahmedabad-Indore-Ahmedabad	1,02,000	1,03,000	0.97
Vijayawada-Mumbai-Vijayawada	1,65,000	1,66,000	0.60
Vijayawada-Kolkata-Vijayawada	1,56,000	1,57,000	0.64
Mumbai-Nagpur-Mumbai	1,15,000	1,16,000	0.86
Mumbai-Pune-Mumbai	68,000	70,000	2.86
Mumbai-Aurangabad-Mumbai	85,000	86,000	1.16
Mumbai-Nashik-Mumbai	68,000	69,000	1.45

Figures in ₹

Source: Subham Freight Carriers India Pvt Ltd

FUTURE FOCUS

Cochin port bolsters gateway status

HEALTHY RIVALRY. Looking past Vizhinjam's transshipment growth, Cochin port muscles up its container handling capacity

V Sajeev Kumar

Cochin Port Authority (CoPA) is unfazed by the rapid rise of Vizhinjam Port as a transshipment hub and is instead focusing on expanding the International Container Transshipment Terminal (ICTT) at Vallarpadam to strengthen its position as a gateway terminal.

M Angamuthu, Chairperson-in-charge of CoPA, said the port, together with DP World, is preparing an expansion plan to make the ICTT future-ready by deepening the channel draft and augmenting terminal infrastructure to tap the growing opportunities in container traffic, particularly transshipment.

"The expansion plans are aimed at transforming ICTT into a vibrant gateway terminal and transshipment hub," he said in an interaction.

Angamuthu said he does not see Vizhinjam as a direct competitor to Cochin at present, noting that the two ports serve different markets.

"Vizhinjam is primarily a transshipment terminal, whereas Cochin is essentially a gateway terminal, although it also handles a significant volume of transshipment cargo. ICTT has a much larger demand potential as it serves central Kerala, including Kochi, which has major commercial and industrial centres," he said.

However, he acknowledged that draft limitations remain a major challenge for the ICTT in attracting larger vessels as shipping lines increasingly deploy bigger ships to achieve economies of scale.

While Vizhinjam has an 18-m draft, ICTT has 14.5 m. The terminal would need a draft of around 16 m to efficiently handle the next generation of container ships.

CoPA and DP World have jointly proposed to deepen the draft to 16 m as part of the terminal's expansion programme.

Angamuthu highlighted Kochi's strategic advantages, including its proximity to major international shipping routes and strong road, rail and inland waterway connectivity, which offer significant scope for developing integrated port-based industrial zones, logistics parks, and warehousing and value-added distribution facilities.

The advantages position Cochin port as both a major container gateway and a transshipment hub, while complementing the rapid growth of India's maritime sector, he said.

CHALLENGING FACTORS

On the flip side, the limited industrialisation in the hinterland poses a major challenge for the port due to the restricted



ADDING DEPTH. The International Container Transshipment Terminal at Vallarpadam is being readied to handle larger container vessels

growth in cargo. The rising operational cost, especially the high annual maintenance dredging cost, is another worrying issue, he said.

The proximity of the Southern Naval Command imposes restrictions on crane heights and certain waterfront developments. Legacy labour issues, higher manpower costs and productivity constraints are some of the other factors affecting the service quality and overall competitiveness of the port.

Angamuthu said Cochin port had the task of maintaining the channel, so the high annual dredging cost is a severe drain on its resources. The channel is extensively used by the Indian Navy, Coast Guard and Cochin Shipyard without any cost sharing. The port has raised the issue with the government, he said.

To help rationalise the cost, Cochin port undertakes need-based dredging as the profile of the ships calling in at the port varies significantly in terms of draft.

RAIL LINKS

Asked about the idling railway line to ICTT, he said the Container Corporation of India Ltd (Concor) had launched a rail service between Coimbatore and ICTT in 2016 but halted it after about 10 months due to viability issues. The rail service could not compete effectively with road transport on the short 190 km stretch between Coimbatore and Kochi.

The GST rollout in July 2017, the consequent shutdown of inter-State checkpoints, and significant improvements in



M Angamuthu, Chairperson-in-charge, Cochin Port Authority

road connectivity between Cochin and Coimbatore (NH-544) also favoured road service. Today, the rail service between Coimbatore and ICTT can be revitalised only through significant cost reduction.

DP World is exploring the idea of establishing a rail service between Bengaluru and ICTT. The nearly 500 km distance augurs well for rail service vis-à-vis a road link, subject to demand potential.

He said the Kerala government's proposed Mission Samudra is in sync with the port's development objectives under the Centre's Sagarmala Programme, especially in terms of multimodal infrastructure connectivity, port-led industrialisation, green shipping and shipbuilding, and blue economy and tourism.

The Cochin-Vizhinjam cluster has the potential to become a dual-hub model for South India, reducing dependency on foreign transshipment ports and offering more options to global shipping lines, he pointed out.

He acknowledged that a few small shipping services that had earlier, in 2014-19, connected ICTT with the non-major ports of Kollam, Beypore and Azhikkal were irregular and were discontinued due to lack of viability.

The redevelopment of Willingdon Island, he said, hinges on capitalising Kochi's growing potential in heritage and cultural tourism, cruise tourism, leisure and coastal tourism, and medical and wellness tourism.

BERTH UPGRADATION

The port plans to upgrade the Q7 berth into a dry cargo terminal, especially for steel. In addition, the Q6 berth and the boat train pier will remain fully mechanised cement terminals, apart from handling other dry cargo.

The port sees a major growth opportunity in handling petroleum, oil, and lubricants (POL) cargo, alongside container handling and monetisation of land.

Ongoing infrastructure initiatives include reconstruction of the Q3 and North Coal berths as POL terminals, the leasing of adjacent land for tank farms connecting to these berths, and the leasing of land at Puthuvyppeen for handling POL products (other than LPG) through the Multi-User Liquid Terminal.

LIGHTING THE RUNWAY

Safe landings in Mangaluru



ALL CLEAR. A plane approaches runway 24 at Mangaluru airport, past the precision approach lighting system towers

A J Vinayak

Aircraft landing at the Mangaluru International Airport has become safer, especially under poor visibility, with the recent commissioning of the precision approach lighting (PAL) category I system for runway 24.

Approved by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, the PAL system has been mounted on 17 massive towers erected in the valley below the tabletop runway at the airport.

The system features airfield lighting intelligent management systems (ALIMS) mounted on the specially engineered towers, extending 900 m outwards from the runway threshold.

The system provides a clear visual reference for pilots during landing approach, particularly in low-visibility conditions, such as rain, fog or haze, at a tabletop facility, such as the airport in Mangaluru.

The lighting configuration enables precise alignment with the runway centreline.

Airport officials say the system significantly improves pilot confidence and approach stability, given the topographical characteristics of the tabletop runway in Mangaluru. Enhanced visual cues aid a smoother landing, thereby improving operational efficiency and minimising disruptions.

The use of ALIMS ensures centralised monitoring and efficient management of airfield lighting systems.

According to Amber Dubey, CEO (Aero) of Adani Airports, Mangaluru, is only the second tabletop airport in Asia with such a system, after Chongqing in China. He says the tallest of these towers exceeds the height of the Qutub Minar in Delhi by 10 m.

Capt Brijesh Chowta, Dakshina Kannada MP, says enhanced operational reliability will strengthen Mangaluru's status as an important gateway connecting coastal Karnataka with the rest of India and the world.

The Mangaluru airport has introduced several measures to improve the safety of aircraft operations after an Air India Express flight from Dubai overshoot the runway during landing, leaving 158 people dead, in 2010. To improve runway visibility, it had earlier installed centreline lights — inset lights that complement the runway edge and threshold lights.



TUNE-UP. Aircraft engine shops must multiply as India's fleet expands

multiplicative, with faster turn-around, lower logistics cost, shared utilities and infrastructure, and a talent pool that deepens with every new entrant.

The cluster strategy requires a deliberate sequencing of investment: First, anchor the zone with an engine shop partnered with an original equipment manufacturer (OEM), and then widen the web of OEM-licensed joint ventures, each targeting a specific layer of the component repair chain.

TALENT PIPELINE

Workforce constraint is a factor that no amount of capital can bypass. An engine overhaul shop runs on certified technicians with specific type of ratings, which are OEM-approved and built over years of supervised practice. India needs these at scale, through OEM-operated training schools, OEM-MRO partnerships with local polytechnics offering final immersion at engine shops, and reskilling engineers from adjacent industries like defence and automotive. The talent pipeline is also the retention pipeline: An engineer trained, type-rated, employed and competitively paid within India is far less likely to emigrate.

Indian MRO facilities face duplicated approval costs and are structurally limited in their ability

to service foreign-registered and leased aircraft. The lessor landscape adds a further challenge as nearly 80 per cent of India's civil fleet is on sale-and-leaseback.

An overdue bilateral agreement with the European Union Aviation Safety Agency would open India's MRO facilities to the global maintenance market, not just the domestic one.

India's engine MRO demand is compounding faster than capacity can be built, yet the foundational ingredients for a world-class ecosystem are already in place. The fleet scale is here and growing faster than any comparable market, the engineering talent base is deep, and the policy direction is positive. French multinational aerospace corporation Safran's LEAP facility in Hyderabad, alongside a co-located training facility, is the catalyst. Every OEM conversation and policy decision that follows should answer one question: Does it keep 80 per cent of engine repair value on Indian soil?

The writer is the Global Head of Presales and Solution Consulting - Aviation, Aerospace and Defence at Ramco Systems

We value your feedback. Do send your comments to bl.logistics@thehindu.co.in

MY FIVE.

SURESH KHADAKBHAVI
Chief Executive Officer,
Digi Yatra Foundation



Brisk walk, clean eating and
some refined no-nos

- Brisk walk:** My day begins between 3.30 and 4 am. I start with 30-45 minutes of stretching and strength work (core, chest, legs and arms), followed by an hour of brisk walking outdoors. This early start sets the tone for everything that follows.
- Eat clean:** I stick to two meals a day. Millets, pulses, brown rice, Mediterranean salad (only on weekends), seasonal fruits and home-style Indian dishes form the base. The day, however, always begins with masala tea sweetened with jaggery.
- Refined no-no:** I keep things light, simple, and consistent by avoiding white sugar, white salt, flour, milk and white rice.
- Show up:** Five days a week, I spend nearly two hours working out, usually finishing before 6 am. I rely on a mix of app-based routines and the occasional weight session to keep things varied.
- Slow evenings:** Dinner is before 9 pm — a light and clean home-cooked meal. Evenings are for unwinding with family before I end the day by 10.30 pm.

CAPSULE.

Reversing the cancer spread

Millions of people are facing the physical, emotional and financial toll of cancer, a disease that claims more than 26,000 lives every day, said a report from the World Health Organization (WHO). With an estimated 20.6 million new cases and close to 10 million deaths annually, cancer remains the second



leading cause of death globally, after cardiovascular disease, it added.
Reversing this trend will require a fundamental shift towards a people-centred approach that responds to the health needs and lived experiences of affected people and communities. Without urgent action, the number of annual cancer cases is projected to rise to nearly 35 million by 2050, the UN health agency said.
The WHO Global Status Report on Cancer 2026, developed jointly with the International Agency for Research on Cancer (IARC), provides an analysis of the progress across areas, including political commitment, cancer prevention, particularly through tobacco control and vaccination programmes, and investment in treatment.
The report reveals persistent and widening inequities in access to prevention, diagnosis, treatment and supportive care, leaving millions of people without the services they need. Its analysis shows that while 87 per cent of women with breast cancer survive at five years after diagnosis in high-income countries, only about 42 per cent do so in low-income countries. Fewer than one in three countries currently include cancer care in their universal health coverage packages.

COMING UP.

Turning the tide

Drowning claims more than 3,00,000 lives a year — 30 every hour — and almost a quarter of the victims are children under five. Globally, it is among the 10 leading causes of death for children aged 5-14, the World Health Organization said, ahead of World Drowning Prevention Day (July 25). This year's theme is "Unite to turn the tide", a call to every sector and every level of society to join hands to reduce drowning by 35 per cent by 2035.

● MINDFUL WELL-BEING

Goal-oriented remedies

BEYOND TRADITIONAL THERAPY. CBT provides mental health support in a changing world

Gayatri Sundaravadanan

Vihaan (name changed) sits at his desk, head bent over a textbook. His NEET exam is three days away. "Will I pass?" he wonders. A notification pops up on his phone. His classmate messages to say he has received a scholarship from a prestigious university. Vihaan views this as his own failure, makes unhelpful comparisons and catastrophises.
In cognitive behavioural therapy (CBT), such reactions are described as distortions of perception. "Unhelpful thoughts such as 'My life is bad because I am not able to write the competitive exams on time, I am a failure, etc' do not provide any clear solutions," says Keerthi Pai, Clinical Psychologist, Element H Psychological Support Services, Chennai.
Unlike other traditional forms of therapy, such as psychoanalysis, CBT is goal-oriented to solve present-day problems rather than explore the distant past. And it is becoming an avenue of mental health support for the young and elderly alike.
"CBT helps the individual first identify such unhelpful thoughts through a thought journal and then, through Socratic questioning, the therapist or psychologist is able to help the individual understand core beliefs; next, through the process of cognitive restructuring, the psychologist is able to help the individual restructure these unhelpful thoughts and core beliefs. This breaks the path of self-destructive thoughts and behaviours," Pai says.
Research shows CBT to be effective in many mental health conditions, making it one of the most evidence-based psychological treatments available, according to several experts. CBT-based interventions are increasingly used to manage stress, burnout, perfectionism and work-life imbalance.
According to another CBT therapist, "There is an acceptance of this form of therapy in In-



PEN IT. A 'thought journal' is part of cognitive behavioural therapy ISTOCK

dia today because the concept is 'goal-oriented', focusing on the 'here and now'.
"Awareness of CBT has increased substantially over the past decade due to greater public discussion of mental health, online resources, and its inclusion in treatment guidelines worldwide," says Dr OT Sabari Sridhar, Professor and Head of the Department of Psychiatry, Sri Ramachandra Medical College and Research Institute, Chennai.
ADAPTIVE THINKING
There are misconceptions about CBT as mere "positive thinking" when, in fact, it is a "structured, evidence-based therapy", says Dr Sridhar. It focuses on examining the current problem and the factors leading to it, and requires the individual to be committed to the treatment plan.
CBT has been shown to be effective in helping teenagers deal with emotional and physical health challenges. For instance, it has helped reduce the frequency and severity of migraine headaches in adolescents.
And in a time of all-pervading social media, it can address the 'fear of missing out' (FOMO) syndrome, as also the fallout of digital overexposure. By teaching coping strategies, stress management techniques, healthier digital habits and adaptive thinking patterns, CBT aims to improve both psychological well-being and the overall quality of life.
Among middle-aged people

and the elderly, CBT helps with illness acceptance and lowering the anxiety associated with chronic illnesses such as Parkinson's disease, stroke and cancer. It works alongside complementary therapies such as existential therapy, gestalt therapy, acceptance commitment therapy, and solution-focused brief therapy, among others. CBT also helps adults accept the diagnosis without judgment and achieve a qualitatively healthy lifestyle in accordance with their values, says Pai.
For instance, a person anxious about attending social gatherings is given not just reassurance or affirmation but also assistance with identifying and reframing the thought and behaviour that sustain the anxiety. The individual may be encouraged to attend a party for a limited period — perhaps just an hour. This small, manageable step serves as a behavioural experiment designed to challenge anxious assumptions in a real-world setting, says a CBT therapist.
This could be followed up with reflective questions in the next session. How many people spoke to you? Did any situation make you uncomfortable? How did you feel when you got home?
By examining the responses, the individual can reassess their fears and develop a more balanced, realistic perspective about social situations.
The therapy duration depends on individual condition and severity. Typically, it involves eight to 20 sessions and follow-ups, as needed. Each session lasts 45-60 minutes, usually weekly, and there is some "homework" to be reviewed in subsequent sessions.
"Research over the last few decades indicates that at least 30 per cent of those who received combined CBT and a course of medical treatment have had good improvement in their occupational skills and self-care," the therapist says, adding that greater personalisation of CBT is anticipated with the growth in digital technologies and artificial intelligence-assisted intervention.

● FROM THE REGULATOR

Spotlighting gender gaps in pharma R&D



ISTOCK

The European Medicines Agency (EMA) is launching initiatives to better embed women's health considerations in medicine development and regulation. Women live longer than men on average but spend more of their lives in poorer health. This disparity is due to societal aspects, as well as gaps in disease prevention, diagnosis, and treatments, which do not always fully address their specific health needs.
"This is an area where we are seeing strong momentum at the EU and global level, and where EMA is well placed to drive meaningful progress and help shape a clear path ahead. As medicine regulators, we have a role to play to enable the development of products that are better tailored to women's needs," said EMA Executive Director Emer Cooke.
Women's healthcare is influenced by a combination of factors, including the representation of women in clinical research, persistent gaps in understanding sex-based differences in disease and treatment effect, and the need to better integrate these differences in the development and use of medicines. As a result, some treatments do not fully meet women's specific needs, and certain conditions, such as preeclampsia, menopausal symptoms and endometriosis, remain insufficiently recognised or addressed.
EMA is holding a women's health workshop on September 28-29, where it will examine research gaps across the spectrum of women's health needs, identify priorities to strengthen the evidence base and support more inclusive clinical research. It will explore further opportunities, drawing on inputs from patients, healthcare professionals, academia, industry and global partners.
EMA is already engaged in four main areas — representation in clinical trials, assessment and labelling of medicines, use of medicines during pregnancy and breastfeeding, and real-world evidence studies. The agency plans to organise more activities.

Source: EMA

LENS ON HEALTH



INTERESTED PARTIES. Visitors in Berlin watch as members of Germany's lower house of Parliament, the Bundestag, vote during a plenum session on a Bill aimed at reining in health insurance costs REUTERS

Data safety law must treat health records distinctly

BY INVITATION

MILIND ANTANI

Patient trust is the cornerstone of healthcare. Having practised as a surgeon before transitioning to healthcare law, I have seen how the doctor-patient relationship depends on the assurance that sensitive medical information remains confidential and secure. As India's healthcare ecosystem becomes increasingly digital, the question is no longer whether health data should be protected, but whether it warrants protection distinct from other forms of personal data.
The Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP Act), 2023, has established India's first comprehensive framework for digital personal data governance. While its consent-centric approach may be suitable for many sectors, healthcare presents unique ethical, operational and public interest considerations.
A significant gap in the DPDP Act is its failure to distinguish health information from ordinary personal data. Unlike the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), which classifies health information as a "special category" requiring heightened protection, the DPDP Act applies a uniform framework for all personal data. As a result, a patient's psychiatric history, HIV status, genetic profile or cancer diagnosis receives the same statutory treatment as an individual's name or email address, despite the vastly different consequences of disclosure.
This distinction is reflected in constitutional jurisprudence. In *KS Puttaswamy vs Union of India* (2017), the Supreme Court recognised informational privacy and bodily autonomy as integral to the fundamental right to privacy, acknowledging the harm from unauthorised disclosure of medical information.
Specialised safeguards become even more inalienable when involving genetic and genomic data. Genetic data is immutable, uniquely identifiable and capable of revealing information about individuals and their biological relatives. Misuse in employment, insurance or social set-



FOR PATIENT'S EYES ONLY. Keep medical records private ISTOCK

tings can have lifelong consequences.
The Act's reliance on consent also presents practical challenges. Healthcare delivery often requires rapid information-sharing among treatment providers, particularly during emergencies. The framework should, therefore, recognise deemed or implied consent while maintaining accountability and safeguards.
Similarly, for cross-border data transfers the Act may be insufficient for sensitive medical information. While data flows are essential for research and innovation, safeguards are necessary when genetic, reproductive, biometric or mental health data is processed outside India.
RIGHT TO ERASURE
Record retention is yet another area of concern. The DPDP Act grants individuals the right to seek erasure of personal data, yet healthcare providers are often required to preserve medical records for treatment, insurance claims, regulatory investigations and medico-legal purposes.
All of this makes a case for a healthcare-specific carve-out under the DPDP Act. Such a framework should also align with initiatives such as the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission. The recently announced unified health interface Aarogya Setu 2.0 and other digital health initiatives have the potential to become healthcare's UPI moment in India.
A well-designed framework must protect patient dignity and confidentiality while ensuring the regulation never becomes a barrier to care itself.

The writer is Lead, Pharmaceutical and Life Sciences Practice, Nishith Desai Associates. Views are personal

Generic semaglutide adoption: It's all about the delivery device

The absence of standardisation leaves patients confused and doctors hesitant to prescribe

Rajiv Kovil

The arrival of generic semaglutide in India was expected to make obesity and diabetes treatment more affordable and accessible. Many believed that once patents expired, the market would rapidly shift towards lower-cost alternatives. Surprisingly, that hasn't happened.
Despite competitive pricing, the biggest hurdle to adoption has been not the medicine but how it's delivered.
Semaglutide is a peptide that requires precise administration. Unlike a tablet, it cannot be swallowed. It is injected once a week using specially designed delivery systems. There lies the confusion.
Today, different manufacturers offer semaglutide in reusable pens, disposable pens, pre-filled pens, pre-filled syringes and even vials. Each device has its own loading



INJECTING CONFIDENCE. Dosage is key to semaglutide use ISTOCK

method, priming process, dose selection mechanism and injection technique. For doctors who prescribe several different brands, remembering every device is challenging. And if the doctor is uncertain, it becomes difficult to confidently educate patients.
Patient education is key for injectables to succeed. Multiple devices leave patients confused — some may not

prime the pen correctly, others may dial the wrong dose, and some may struggle with changing the cartridges or needles. This reduces confidence in the treatment and slows adoption.
Then there is storage and in-use shelf life — this, too, varies between products. For example, the in-use shelf life recommendation for Ozempic pens is 42 days, while Mounjaro pens are discarded 30 days

after first use. These recommendations are based on formal stability studies submitted to regulators. Some of the newer reusable pen systems in India are designed to last for several months, after replacing the cartridges. These devices are convenient and potentially economical, but there have been questions about long-term in-use stability, particularly if the medicine remains inside a cartridge for prolonged periods under varying storage conditions. Such questions require answers from stability studies conducted by manufacturers and reviewed by regulators.
Another concern of physicians — each time a pen is reused, a fresh needle pierces the cartridge. Over extended periods of use, clinicians ask whether the repeated punctures, storage conditions and handling could influence sterility or product quality. These are scientific questions that are

addressed through stability and microbiological validation studies before regulatory approval.
Dose accuracy is another concern. Semaglutide is highly effective, but dosing must follow a gradual escalation schedule. Accidentally administering a higher dose can increase gastrointestinal side effects such as nausea, vomiting and dehydration. When patients use multi-dose devices, education becomes essential to minimise dosing errors.
None of this means generic semaglutide will fail. Quite the opposite. As device designs become more standardised, doctors will be more comfortable prescribing them and patients will be more confident using them — a key factor in the next phase of India's obesity and diabetes treatment journey.

The writer is a diabetologist and obesity physician, and the founder of Zandra Healthcare. Views are personal

‘Concerns over restricted access to frontier AI models overblown’

ROAD AHEAD. Next phase of enterprise adoption will hinge more on reimagining business processes: TCS CEO

bl.interview

Vallari Sanzgiri
Thomas K Thomas
Mumbai

Artificial intelligence has become the defining force reshaping the global technology industry, but questions remain over who will ultimately capture the value — from frontier model developers and hyperscalers to IT services firms.

TCS Chief Executive Officer & Managing Director K Krithivasan discusses how AI is changing the economics of IT services, and why the next phase of enterprise adoption will hinge less on the latest models and more on reimagining business processes. *Excerpts:*

AI is delivering 10-15 per cent productivity improvements that you’re sharing with customers. Will the IT services industry eventually become a lower-revenue business unless clients significantly increase the amount of work they outsource?

It does not impact the top line. In fact, we encourage our associates to talk to clients whenever there is an opportunity to deliver high productivity and proactively have the discussion even if it becomes deflationary on the overall top line. Whenever customers see this benefit, they almost always use the extra savings or surplus to deliver more projects. So, it does not net impact the top line. It brings productivity to our customers.

But in two years of

generative AI, why are clients still hesitating? Is it governance, unclear ROI or complexity of scaling?

It is the complexity of the enterprise. Every enterprise is so complex. It’s one thing to do a proof of concept (POC) and find what looks very good. But making it production-ready, scaling it and seeing the true business benefit takes some time. That’s why you have to reimagine the whole process.

Are conversations moving beyond POCs? A lot of companies say AI is not really bringing the expected impact.

That’s where we are helping our customers by saying where the true value lies. In fact, the thesis we have been putting out is that the role of system integrators will only increase and they will continue to remain critical because we understand the customer’s context.

We understand how AI can bring value for them. And we know how we can help them reimagine their business process. I think we will see AI adoption increase.

I don’t think adoption will decrease. That could be always like some short-term disillusionment. But eventually people will realise this is a technology for the future.

Tech giants are now setting up Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE) teams. Do you see this environment getting more competitive?

SaaS players have been there for a long time with their professional services team.

But they still did not displace the system integrators because of the value we bring.



The differentiator we bring in is the knowledge about the customer and how a particular technology can be leveraged to deliver the business outcomes

K KRITHIVASAN
CEO and Managing Director, TCS



Anthropic. Do clients have a preference for one over the other?

There are concerns about trust with some models, but clients are taking a very pragmatic view from a cost perspective. In the end, we expect most customers to use multiple stream models.

Customers will choose based on the workload and the cost. Increasingly, we find many situations where a small language model is more preferred than a large model.

How do you play in an environment that is also controlled by geopolitics, where you do not have access to all the features of a particular platform as it happened recently with Anthropic?

To me, that is overblown because many customers have not even leveraged all the features of the previously released models or what is available to them fully.

While there is always a question of why Mythos is not available to me, a common question we ask customers is: what did you do with the model available to you before? What can you do with the models available to you that can get you as close to what Mythos is. So, it is not a major disadvantage.

Have you looked at any of the Indian sovereign models to deploy?

We have been in good discussions with them, but we also have the capability to create a small model internally.

Do you agree that we need a sovereign model?

We will need a sovereign model because you do not want to lose to the outside world where you do not have complete control.



MARKET FOCUS. The new business verticals will cater to TCS’s North America, Europe and global businesses

vicious business unit — Communications, Media, Information Services & Technology — will be integrated as a single business group and led by V Rajanna, who currently heads the Technology, Software & Services Business Group.

Rajanna will focus on strengthening the company’s market position, deepening client engagement across each segment and unlocking new growth opportunities and will report to K Krithivasan, CEO and MD at TCS.

The company also announced a separate business group for its US West Coast operations, home to many of the leading companies in technology, semiconductors and software.

INDUSTRY SEGMENTS

The business group will focus on accelerating growth of industry segments like AI, quantum, semiconductors and product engineering.

Beyond client growth, the unit will play an important role in bringing together technology companies, startups, academia and other ecosystem partners. Akhilesh Tripathi will lead this new group, while also leading the Digitate business in the interim.

Describing ServiceNow as a “strategically important platform ecosystem”, the company launched a dedicated business unit for it. This department will be headed by Rajnish Palande, current

ISU Head for BFSI Americas, US East Insurance at TCS, who will take over as Global Head of the ServiceNow Practice. Palande will be responsible for driving the global ServiceNow agenda, ensuring end-to-end accountability for customer success and ServiceNow as-customer engagements. In this role, Palande will report to Vikram Karakoti, Global Head, Enterprise Solutions.

TCS announced Kumar Narayanan, current ISU Head of North America Energy & Resources, as the head of the Cybersecurity unit. Previously, Narayanan led the North America Energy & Resources ISU and will report to Subramanian.

Sabyasachi Chandra, who currently heads the North America Utilities unit, will take over Narayanan’s earlier role.

Meanwhile, Ganesh Vaikuntam, who currently leads the Cybersecurity Service Line, will take over as the ISU Head for Life Sciences UK and Europe.

Palande’s former BFSI Americas segment will be reorganised into two business groups with Rakesh Kumar, current ISU Head for BFSI US West, and Mohan Veeturi, the current ISU Head for BFSI US East Banking, assuming the roles of Business Group Heads.

Susheel Vasudevan, the current business group head BFSI Americas, will move to a strategic role, reporting to Krithivasan.

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